

The Survival Game

A fantasy survival game with a side of romance! Explore, collect, and fight to survive in a magical low-poly world. Fight bosses, and maybe you'll even find true love!

Date	Version	Changes Made
05/04/2026	0.1.1	First Draft Complete

1. Project Info

A. **Game Title:** The Survival Game

B. **Author / Team:**

- a. Anastasia Davis
- b. Elena Hernandez
- c. Jairus Legion

C. **Platform(s):** Computer, PC

D. **Engine / Tools:** Unity Game Engine

E. **Monetization Model:** Free to play

2. Game Overview & Vision

- A. **High Concept:** In this “Legend of Zelda: Breath of the Wild” meets “Stardew Valley” game, players must survive in a new environment while gathering resources and building their survival skills.
- B. **Game Summary:** At the start of the game the player will be placed in the middle of the world map with different biomes to each side. The player will be able to collect resources and fight enemies found throughout the world. At key points, important boss enemies will be placed that will contribute to quest progression for the romance storyline.
- C. **Player Journey Snapshot:** In the first ten minutes the player will explore the world and collect resources such as wood and flowers. Later on the player will be able to craft equipment and fight enemies as they wish to romance the main NPC.
- D. **Unique Selling Points (USP):** This survival game does not solely emphasize surviving. Players are encouraged to gather resources and explore this fantasy world as they seek to discover the rare materials in the environment. They can also interact and battle NPCs in one of the side quests/storylines.
- E. **Target Audience:** This game is geared towards players who enjoy open-world survival games.
- F. **Genre & Inspirations:** The main genres of this game are fantasy and survival. We were inspired by games such as “Don’t Starve Together”, “The Legend of Zelda: Breath of the Wild”, and “Payday 2”.
- G. **Tone & Look & Feel:** The game uses a calm and simple environment. The assets are purposefully low-poly to emphasize the simple fantasy elements throughout the world.

3. Core Gameplay Design

A. Core Gameplay Loop :

- a. Explore → Gather Items → Survive → Repeat
- b. Fight NPCs → Win → Increased Chances with Love Interest

B. **Player Progression:** The player can improve chances with the love interest by defeating the enemies.

C. **Controls & Input:** The game relies on using a keyboard and mouse (or trackpad) to control the player. The player moves with the “WASD” keys and looks around with the mouse (or trackpad). Players can open their inventory using the “I” key, and they can view their stats with the “K” key.

D. **Difficulty & Challenge:** The baseline difficulty will be fairly easy, geared toward casual video game players rather than experts.

E. **Feedback Systems:** When a player gets close enough to an item to pick it up the item's name will appear over it when the mouse hovers on it.



Fig. 1 - An example of the material hover text.

4. Game Mechanics & Systems

A. Core Mechanics:

- a. Inventory system
- b. Resource gathering
- c. Health bar

B. Side Mechanics:

- a. Minimap navigation

C. **Interaction Mechanics:** The player will navigate the world in the first person, clicking on materials to pick them up and fighting enemies the same way. There will also be dialogue trees to interact with the main NPC.

D. **Economy & Resources:** Collectibles will be found throughout the world for achievement oriented players. Resources will be used for crafting rather than selling.



Fig. 2 - The inventory and minimap systems.

5. Narrative, World, & Characters

- A. **Themes & Emotional Arc:** The game is meant to be light-hearted and does not have major emotional themes, however it does touch on the idea of proving oneself.
- B. **Story Overview:** The player has traveled to a magic-embued area in search of rare materials.
- C. **Worldbuilding:** The game is set within a magical environment full of rare and wondrous resources.
- D. **Main Characters:** The player controls a traveller that has come to the region in order to collect rare materials. The major (unnamed) NPC is a love interest that the player can attempt to romance.
- E. **Player Agency:** The only choice the player can make to affect the world is whether or not to fight the bosses and romance the main NPC.

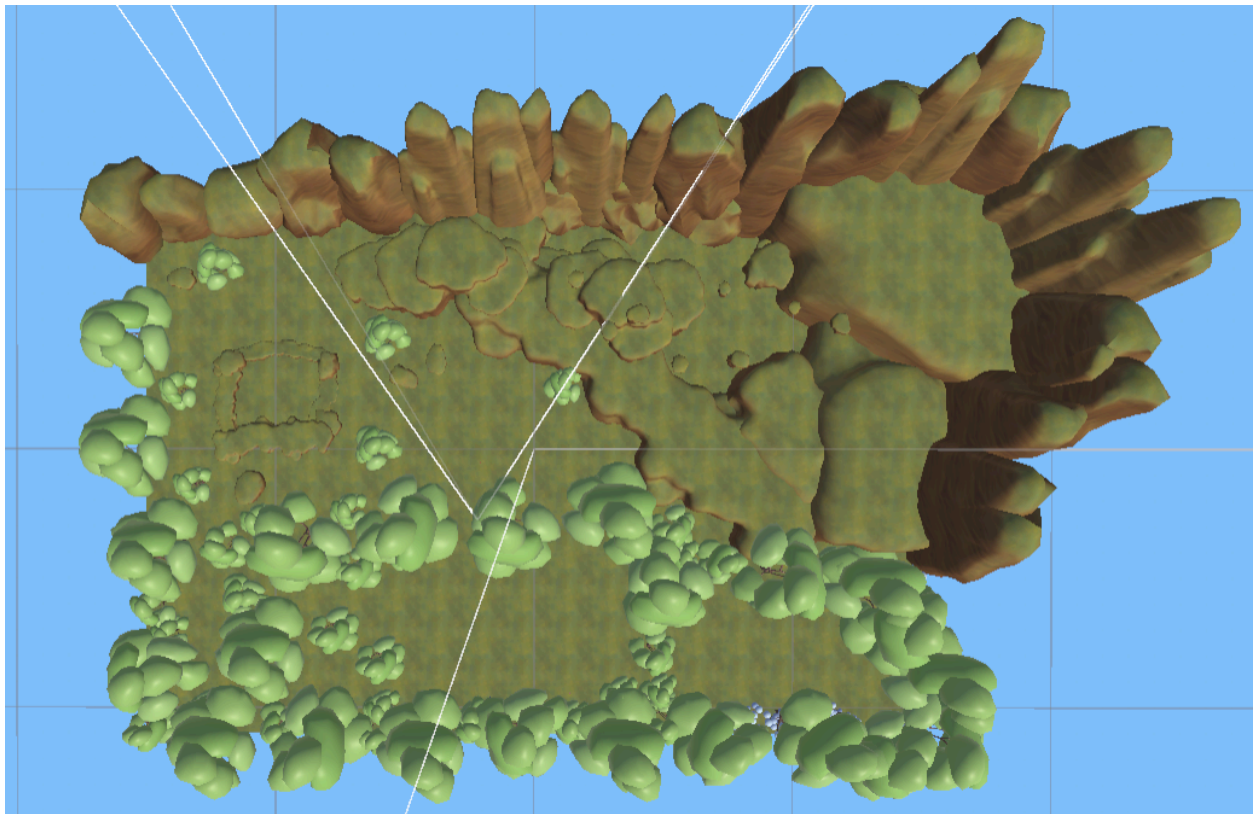


Fig. 3 - A screenshot of the game world layout.

6. Level & Encounter Design

- A. **Objectives:** The player's main goal in this game is to survive and try to win their love interest's affection.
- B. **Structure & Layout:** There are three main areas (terrains) that the player can explore: a rocky (mountain) terrain, a forest terrain, and a hybrid rocky-forest terrain.
- C. **Gameplay Flow:** The player starts the game in the magical environment and the narrative informs the player they need to survive while making the most of their time in the area (namely by gathering resources).
- D. **Interactive Elements:** Resources found scattered throughout the world, as well as the NPC and enemies.
- E. **Progression Gates:** No progression gates, the player can challenge bosses in whatever order they wish.
- F. **Environmental Storytelling:** No environmental storytelling other than the magic naturally imbued into the resources and environment.



Fig. 4 – An (initial) overview of game environment.

7. UI, UX, & Accessibility

Covers how players interact with the game outside of direct mechanics, especially through screens and inputs.

⚠ If this section is blank, your player will suffer even if the mechanics are great. Here, clarity trumps cleverness.

- A. **Core UI Elements:** Health Bar, screen crosshair, minimap navigator, inventory system, skill stats system
- B. **Menus & Screens:** The game opens with an opening menu and when the player dies they have the choice to respawn or return to the main menu.
- C. **HUD Design:** A minimap and clock are shown persistently during gameplay.
- D. **UX Flow:** Each menu is opened using a keybind, namely “I” and “K”.
- E. **Onboarding:** The game teaches itself by introducing various elements slowly as the player explores. Resources near the starting area teach the player how to collect materials, while easy enemies teach the player how to fight and avoid damage.
- F. **Accessibility Options:** Accessibility options are tentatively scheduled to be added in version 2.0.



Fig. 5 - A testing version of the skill menu and main menu.